

Employee Leave Policy

Human Resources Department • Effective Date: January 1, 2025 • Version 3.2

1. Purpose & Scope

This policy establishes the framework for employee leave entitlements at ACME Corporation. It applies to all full-time and part-time permanent employees across all departments and locations globally.

This policy supersedes all prior leave-related circulars and guidelines. Contract and freelance workers are governed by their respective agreements and are not covered under this policy.

2. Leave Entitlements

The following table summarizes all leave categories available to eligible employees:

Leave Type	Entitlement	Carry Forward	Max Encashment
Annual Leave	21 Days/Year	Up to 10 Days	10 Days
Sick Leave	10 Days/Year	No	None
Maternity Leave	90 Days	N/A	None
Paternity Leave	7 Days	No	None
Bereavement Leave	3 Days	No	None
Unpaid Leave	As Approved	N/A	None

3. Annual Leave

3.1 Eligibility & Accrual

All permanent employees are entitled to 21 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accrued at a rate of 1.75 days per month. New employees begin accruing leave from their first day of employment but may only utilize accrued leave after completing a 3-month probationary period.

3.2 Application Process

- Submit leave requests via the HR Portal at least 5 working days in advance for leave of 3 days or fewer.
- For leave exceeding 3 days, a minimum of 10 working days' notice is required.
- Emergency leave may be granted with same-day approval at the Line Manager's discretion.
- All leave requests are subject to operational requirements and Line Manager approval.

3.3 Carry Forward & Encashment

Employees may carry forward up to 10 unused annual leave days to the next calendar year. Carry-forward days must be utilized by March 31 of the following year or they will lapse. A maximum of 10 days may be encashed upon separation from the organization.

4. Sick Leave

4.1 Entitlement

Each employee is entitled to 10 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Sick leave does not carry forward and cannot be encashed. Sick leave cannot be used in lieu of annual leave.

4.2 Medical Documentation

- Absences of 1-2 consecutive days: Self-declaration via the HR Portal is sufficient.
- Absences of 3 or more consecutive days: A medical certificate from a registered practitioner must be submitted within 2 working days of return.
- Repeated short-term sick leave patterns may be subject to review by HR and the employee's Line Manager.

5. Maternity & Paternity Leave

5.1 Maternity Leave

Eligible female employees are entitled to 90 consecutive calendar days of paid maternity leave. Leave may commence up to 4 weeks before the expected due date. Documentation including a medical certificate confirming the expected delivery date must be submitted to HR at least 8 weeks prior to the leave commencement date.

5.2 Paternity Leave

Eligible male employees are entitled to 7 consecutive working days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 30 days of the child's birth or adoption. A birth certificate or adoption order must be submitted to HR within 10 working days of the event.

6. Bereavement Leave

Employees are entitled to 3 working days of paid bereavement leave upon the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling). Additional unpaid leave may be granted at the Line Manager's discretion for extended family members or extenuating circumstances.

7. Unpaid Leave

Employees with at least 2 years of continuous service may apply for unpaid leave for personal reasons, further education, or extended travel. Approval is at the sole discretion of the department head and HR Director. Unpaid leave does not affect years-of-service calculations but will reduce pro-rated bonus eligibility for the affected year.

8. Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to all gazetted public holidays as declared by the government each year. If an employee is required to work on a public holiday, they are entitled to a substitute day off within 30 days or an additional day's pay at the basic rate, as agreed with the Line Manager.

9. Policy Violations

Misuse of leave, including submission of fraudulent medical certificates or abuse of leave provisions, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. All leave records are subject to periodic audit by the HR Department.

10. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually by the HR Department and updated as necessary to reflect changes in applicable labor laws and organizational requirements. Employees will be notified of any material changes via the internal communications portal.

Approved by: Director of Human Resources | Date: January 1, 2025